November 6, 2026

Yujin Kim

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Website
GitHub
Google Scholar

Education

University of Texas at Austin — Ph.D. in Communication Studies — 2022
Moody College of Communication

Dissertation: *How Language Use on Facebook Drives Affective Polarization* (Awarded the 2022 Lynda Lee Kaid Outstanding Dissertation Award by Political Communication Division, National Communication Association)
Committee: Natalie J. Stroud (chair), Roderick Hart, Sharon Jarvis, Josephine Lukito

Seoul National University — MA in Communication — 2016

Thesis: *The Effects of News Media on Incumbents: South Korea's National Assembly Members* (Advisor: Kyu S. Hahn)

Chung Ang University — Double BA in Mass Communication, English Language and Literature — 2011
Exchange Student: San Diego State University (Fall 2009 - Spring 2010)

Appointments

Center for Media Engagement
University of Texas at Austin
Affiliated Research Associate — August 2026 - Present
Conducting computational political communication research on affective and multimodal political discourse, polarization, and digital media at scale.

Wesleyan Media Project
Quantitative Analysis Center
Wesleyan University
Postdoctoral Research Fellow — July 2024 - June 2026
Led large-scale multimodal analysis of political media messaging across television, digital advertising, and social platforms.

Center for Media Engagement
University of Texas at Austin
Postdoctoral Research Fellow — June 2022 - July 2024
Continued from Knight Research Associate (2020-2024)
Studied political discourse and polarization on social media using large-scale computational text analysis.

Research Interests

- Polarization, Public Opinion, Social Media & Technology, Online Engagement, Journalism & Media Studies
- Computational Social Science, Quantitative Analysis, Interdisciplinary Approaches, Multimodal Analysis
- Programming/Software/Computing: R, Python, STATA, Git/Github, Google Cloud, MySQL, AWS

Publications

Journal Articles (peer-reviewed unless indicated otherwise; IF referenced in 2026)

Kim, Y., & Stroud, N. J. (2026). Cross-Ideological Sharing and Counterargument. *Humanities and Social Sciences Communications* (published online). [DOI] [Harvard Dataverse] (IF = 4.8, 5-Year)

Curry, A. L., **Kim, Y.,** Murray, C., Graham, E., & Stroud, N. J. (2026). Mapping Gaps in Local News Coverage. *Journalism Studies,* 1-19. [DOI] (IF = 4.2, 5-Year)

Kim, Y. (2026). Negativity vs. Incivility: How We Engage with Partisan Content on Facebook Over Time. *Mass Communication and Society*, 1-27. [DOI] (IF = 4.0, 5-Year) [OSF Repository]

Franz, M. M., Ridout, T. N., Fowler, E. F., **Kim, Y.**, Zhang, M., Floyd, B., & Olienikov, P. (2026). Television and Digital Advertising in the 2024 U.S. Presidential Campaign. *Journal of Political Marketing*, 1-19. [DOI] (IF = 2.3, 5-Year)

Collier, J., **Kim, Y.** & Murray, C. (2026). The Composition and Amplification of Mainstream Political Memes: Evidence from 4 U.S. Election Cycles. *Journal of Information Technology & Politics, 23*(1), 72–87. [DOI] (IF = 3.3, 5-Year)

Gollust, S., **Kim, Y.,** Kissell, P. E., & Fowler, E. F. (2025). Using New Techniques to Examine the Past: A Computational Assessment of the First 50 Years of the Journal of Health Politics, Policy and Law. *Journal of Health Politics, Policy and Law, 50*(6), 847-875.[DOI] (Special Issue)

Fowler, E. F., Floyd, B., Zhang, M., **Kim, Y.,** Ridout, T. N., Oleinikov, P., & Franz, M. M. (2025). Election Advertising on Meta, Google, and Snapchat in 2024. *The Forum, 22*(2-3), 283-307. [DOI] (Invited)

Kim, Y., Collier, J., Murray, C., & Stroud, N. J. (2023). Partisan Memes as a Catalyst for Homophilous Networks. *Political Communication, 40*(6), 768-787. [DOI] (IF = 8.9, 5-Year)

Budak. C, Stroud, N. J., Muddiman, A., Murray, C. C., & **Kim, Y.** (2023). The Stability of Cable and Broadcast News Intermedia Agenda Setting Across the COVID-19 Issue Attention Cycle. *Political Communication, 40*(6), 827-847. [DOI] (IF = 8.9, 5-Year)

Stroud, N. J., Scacco, J. M., & **Kim, Y.** (2022). Passive Learning and Incidental Exposure to News. *Journal of Communication, 72*(4), 451-460. [DOI] (IF = 7.6, 5-Year)

Muddiman, A., Budak. C, Murray, C. C., **Kim, Y.**, & Stroud, N. J. (2022). Indexing Theory During an Emerging Health Crisis: How U.S. TV News Indexed Elite Perspectives and Amplified COVID-19 Misinformation. *Annals of the International Communication Association, 46*(3), 174-204. [DOI]

Budak, C., Muddiman, A., **Kim, Y.**, Murray, C. C., & Stroud, N. J. (2021). COVID-19 Coverage by Cable and Broadcast Networks. In *Proceedings of the International AAAI Conference on Web and Social Media,* (15), 952-960. [DOI]

Kim, Y., Collier, J., & Stroud, N. J. (2021). The Effectiveness of Gain and Loss Frames in News Subscription Appeals. *Digital Journalism, 9*(3), 300-318. [DOI] (IF = 7.5, 5-Year)

Collier, J., **Kim, Y.**, & Stroud, N. J. (2020). How News Images Affect Clicking on Subscription Appeals. *Journalism Practice*, *15*(4), 489-507. [DOI] (IF = 3.0, 5-Year)

Jang, S., **Kim, Y.,** Lee, B. J., & Hahn, K. S. (2015). Who Becomes Exposed to Celebrity Activism on Twitter? A Case Study on Oisoo Lee, *Asian Communication Research*, *12*(1), 60-81.

Book Chapters

Stroud, N. J., & **Kim, Y.** (2021). Chapter 26: Measure Newsroom Effectiveness Differently (pp.227-234). In R. P. Hart (Ed.). *Fixing American Politics*: *Solutions for the Media Age*. Routledge.

Publications Under Review

Kim, Y. Beyond Volume to Direction in Partisan Facebook Content and Aggregate Party-Evaluation Divergence in the United States, 2008–2020. (revised and resubmitted)

Lee, T., **Kim, Y**., & McKinney. When AI is Everywhere: Examining Epistemic Consequences of AI News Fatigue and Avoidance.

Working Papers

Zhang, M., Moerira, N., **Kim, Y**., Moore, S., Cakmak, F., Floyd, B., Gollust., Niederdeppe, J., Lewis N. Jr., & Fowler, E. F. Competitive Messaging on Race and Racism in Local News.

Kim, Y., Franz, M. M., Fowler, E. F., Ridout, T. N., Floyd, B., & Olienikov, P. Strategy as the Primary Driver of Political Ad Content.

Stroud, N. J., Murray, C., **Kim, Y.**, Masullo, G., & Overgaard, C. The Effects of Removing News Comments and Changing News Comment Platforms.

Kim, Y. & Collier, J. Visual, Semantic, and Rhetorical Complexity in Political Memes. [OSF Preregistration]

Kim, Y. Partisan Memes and Affective Engagement Across Election Cycles.

Kim, Y. Performative Neutrality: An Algorithmic Audit of How Aligned AI Systems Represent Politicized Science.

Grant-funded Reports

De Paula Moreira N., Hassan, H., **Kim, Y.,** Zhang, M., Floyd, B., & Fowler, E. F. (September, 2025). The One-Sided Narrative on Immigration and Its Consequences. *Collaborative On Media & Messaging For Health and Social Policy*. [link] Funded by the Robert Wood Johnson Foundation.

Vandewalker, I., Petry, E., Glavin, B., Fowler, E. F., Franz, M. M., Oleinikov, P., Floyd, B., Ridout, T. N., **Kim, Y.** & Zhang, M. (July, 2025). Online Ad Spending in 2024 Election Totaled at Least $1.9 Billion. [link]. *Brennan Center, OpenSecrets, and Wesleyan Media Project*.

Fowler, E. F., Moore, S.T., Zhang, M., de Paula Moreira N., Floyd, B., Cakmak, F., **Kim, Y.,** Lewis N. Jr., Niederdeppe, J., & Gollust, S. (January, 2025). Attention to, Predictors of, and Potential Consequences of Racism and Countermessaging in Mainstream Media. *Collaborative On Media & Messaging For Health and Social Policy*. [link] Funded by the Robert Wood Johnson Foundation.

Fowler, E. F., Franz, M. M., Ridout, T. N., Floyd, B., Oleinikov, P., **Kim, Y.** & Zhang, M. 2024 Elections. 2024 Press Releases. (July 16, [link], August 15 [link], August 29 [link], September 12 [link], September 26 [link], October 10 [link], October 31 [link]). *Wesleyan Media Project*. Funded by the Knight Foundation.

Kim Y., Graham, E., Murray, C. & Stroud, N. J. (August, 2023). Georgia's Local News Ecosystem. *Center for Media Engagement*. [link] Commissioned by the Georgia News Collaborative.

Murray, C., Graham, E., **Kim Y.**, Lee, T., & Stroud, N. J. (August, 2023). Migration Narratives in Chicago Media. *Center for Media Engagement*. [link] Funded by Walder Foundation.

Stroud, N. J., Murray, C., Graham, E., & **Kim, Y.**, & Curry, A. L. (February, 2023). The News Philadelphians Use: Analyzing the Local Media Landscape. *Center for Media Engagement*. [link] Funded by the Lenfest Institute and Independence Public Media Foundation.

Budak, C., **Kim, Y.**, Murray, C., & Stroud, N. J. (March, 2022). Advertiser spending on primetime news throughout the coronavirus pandemic. *Center for Media Engagement*. [link] Funded by JLL Americas, William and Flora Hewlett Foundation, the Knight Foundation, Democracy Fund.

Murray, C., Curry, A., **Kim, Y.**, & Stroud, N. J. (December, 2020). Coronavirus Coverage in Chicago. *Center for Media Engagement*. [link] Funded by the Robert R. McCormick Foundation.

Muddiman, A., Budak, C., Romas, B., **Kim, Y.**, Murray, C., Burniston, M. M., Geiger, J., Purcell, A., Ludzenski, J., Turner, M., Duchovany, M., & Stroud, N. J. (December, 2020). Cable and Nightly Network News Coverage of Coronavirus. *Center for Media Engagement*. [link]. Funded by JLL Americas, William and Flora Hewlett Foundation, the Knight Foundation, Democracy Fund.

Stroud, N. J., Murray, C., & **Kim, Y.** (October, 2020). News Comments: What Happens When They're Gone or When Newsrooms Switch Platforms. *Center for Media Engagement*. [link] Funded by the Knight Foundation, Democracy Fund, and the William and Flora Hewlett Foundation.

Stroud, N. J., Curry, A., Murray, C., & **Kim, Y.** (August, 2020). Chicago Media Mapping. *Center for Media Engagement*. [link] Funded by the Robert R. McCormick Foundation.

Stroud, N. J., **Kim, Y.**, & Collier, J. (September, 2018). Subscription Messages. *Center for Media Engagement*. [link] Funded by the American Press Institute.

Teaching Experience

MBB113 (The mRNA Revolution) Wesleyan University	Guest Lecture titled "The Politics of Distrust: Misinformation, Social Media & COVID Vaccine Hesitancy"	Apr 16, 2026
QAC387 Wesleyan University	Instructor (co-teaching with Prof. Jennifer Rose) Generative AI/LLM Tools for Data Analysis	S26
QAC378 Wesleyan University	Affiliated Faculty Assistant Instructor and Group Lead DeltaLab: Computational Media Analysis	F24,S25, F25,S26
QAC239 Wesleyan University	Instructor (co-teaching with Dr. Meiqing Zhang; Proseminar) Machine Learning Methods for Audio and Video Analysis	F24, S25
CMS 390N University of Texas at Austin	Workshop in Graduate Class: Google API Tutorial [material] Social Media Effects, Professor: Natalie J. Stroud	Sept. 22, 2020

CMS 345 University of Texas at Austin	Graduate Teaching Assistant Media Effects and Politics, Professor: Natalie J. Stroud	S20
CMS 332K University of Texas at Austin	Graduate Teaching Assistant Theories of Persuasion, Professor: Matt McGlone	F16

Conference Participation

Kim, Y. (September, 2026). Outrage, Satire, and Democratic Threat: Partisan Memes and Affective Engagement Across Election Cycles. Abstract accepted (waitlisted) at the annual meeting of the American Political Science Association, Political Communication Pre-Conference in Boston, MA.

Lee, T., **Kim, Y**., & McKinney, T. (August, 2025). To Read or Not to Read AI News, That is Not The Question: Examining Incidental Exposure, Fatigue, Avoidance, Knowledge and News Coverage about AI. Manuscript presented at the annual meeting of the Association for Education in Journalism and Mass Communication, San Francisco, CA.

Kim, Y. (June, 2025). Language Use on Facebook and Affective Polarization in the U.S. Public. Manuscript presented at the annual meeting of the International Communication Association, Denver, CO.

Kim, Y. (December, 2024). Strategic Language in Political Campaigns: Mediated Portrayals vs. Actual Ideological Positions in U.S. TV Advertising During Election Cycles. Presentation presented at the 2024 WMP Post-Election Conference, Middletown, CT.

Collier, J., **Kim, Y.** & Murray, C. (November, 2024). The Composition and Amplification of Mainstream Partisan Memes: Evidence from 4 U.S. Election Cycles. Manuscript presented at the annual meeting of the National Communication Association, New Orleans, LA.

Kim, Y. (September, 2024). Cross-Ideological Diverse Sharing is Motivated, Not Sincere. Poster presented at the annual meeting of the American Political Science Association, Political Communication Division, Philadelphia, PA.

Kim, Y. (May, 2023). How Negative and Uncivil Language Use Engages in Partisan Pages' Content on Facebook. Poster presented at the annual meeting of the International Communication Association, Toronto, Canada.

Stroud, N. J., Murray, C., **Kim, Y.**, Masullo, G., & Overgaard, C. (May, 2023). The Effects of Removing News Comments and Changing News Comment Platforms. Manuscript presented at the annual meeting of the International Communication Association, Toronto, Canada.

Collier, J., & **Kim, Y.**, & Stroud, N. J. (September, 2022). Partisan Memes: A Content and Engagement Analysis across 3 U.S. Election Cycles. Manuscript presented at the annual meeting of the American Political Science Association, Montreal, Canada.

Kim, Y. (June, 2022). How Negative and Uncivil Language on Facebook Affect Partisan Polarization in the American Public. Research presented at the annual meeting of Politics and Computational Social Science [online].

Jennings, J., Muddiman, A., Collier, J., & **Kim, Y.** (September, 2021). State Leadership and COVID-19: How U.S. Governors and the News that Covered Them Changed the Pandemic. Manuscript presented at the annual meeting of the American Political Science Association, Political Communication Pre-Conference in Seattle, WA [online].

Budak, C., Muddiman, A., **Kim, Y.**, Murray, C., & Stroud, N. J. (June, 2021). COVID-19 Coverage By Cable and Broadcast Networks. Manuscript and dataset presented at International Conference on Web and Social Media [online].

Kim, Y. (May, 2021). Affective Language on Facebook and Issue Polarization of Public Opinion. Manuscript presented at annual meeting of the American Association for Public Opinion Research [online].

Collier, J., **Kim, Y.**, & Stroud, N. J. (September, 2020). How Hyperpartisan Memes Drive a Spiral of Homophily on Social Media, and How to Fix it. Manuscript presented at Political Communication Pre-conference of the annual meeting of the American Political Science Association [online].

Kim, Y. (November, 2019). The Impact of Relationship Quality and Partisan In-group/Out-group Perception on Perceived Interpersonal Competence in Political Conversation. Manuscript presented at the annual meeting of the National Communication Association, Baltimore, MD.

Kim, Y. (November, 2019). When Trust in Media Matters: The Moderating Effects of Media Trust in Public Responsiveness. Manuscript presented at the annual meeting of the National Communication Association, Baltimore, MD.

Kim, Y. (August, 2019). Affective Polarization in Online Uncivil Comments: Issues of Gun Control/Ownership, Health Care, Pro-Choice/Pro-Life, and Gay Rights. Manuscript presented at the annual meeting of Politics and Computational Social Science, Georgetown University, Washington, D.C.

Stroud, N. J., Collier, J., & **Kim, Y.** (June, 2019). Processing Polarizing Content. Research presented at Integrity Research Academic Workshop, Facebook HQ, Menlo Park, CA.

Stroud, N. J., **Kim, Y.**, & Collier, J., (May, 2019). Gain and Loss Frames in News Subscription Appeals. Manuscript presented at the annual meeting of the International Communication Association, Washington, D.C.

Collier, J., **Kim, Y.**, & Stroud, N. J. (May, 2019). News Images and Clicking on Subscription Appeals. Manuscript presented at the annual meeting of the International Communication Association, Washington, D.C.

Kim, Y. (May, 2019). Affective Polarization in Online Uncivil Comments. Manuscript presented at the annual meeting of the International Communication Association, Political Communication Division Graduate Student Preconference, Washington, D.C.

Stroud, N. J., Scacco, J. M., & **Kim, Y.** (April, 2019). Passive Learning and Incidental Exposure to News. Manuscript presented at the annual meeting of the Midwest Political Science Association, Chicago, IL.

Hahn K. S. & **Kim, Y.** (August, 2015). Is Polarization of Media Choice Ideological or Affective? Estimating the Influence of Regional Animus in Media Choice in South Korea. Manuscript presented at the annual meeting of the Korean Political Science Association, Gyeongju, Korea.

Grants and Fellowship

Wesleyan University	Research and Professional Development – $2,000 (2024, 2025)
Moody College of Communication University of Texas at Austin	Jesse H. Jones Fellowship – $6,500 (2020-2021)
The Graduate School University of Texas at Austin	David Bruton Jr. Graduate School Fellowship –$1,000 (2020)
The Graduate School University of Texas at Austin	Professional Development Award – $300 (2019)
Moody College of Communication University of Texas at Austin	Moody Graduate Fellowship – $12,000 (2016-2019)
The Graduate School University of Texas at Austin	Graduate School Fellowship – $15,000 (2016-2017)
Korea Student Aid Foundation	Research Scholarship – $6,000 (2014)
Chung Ang University	Academic Achievement Scholarship – $5,000 (2006, 2009)

Research Experience

Moody College of Communication University of Texas at Austin	Graduate Research Associate at Center for Media Engagement (2017-2022)
Seoul National University	Research Associate at Center for Political Communication (2014-2016)

Awards and Honors

Political Communication Division National Communication Association	2022 Lynda Lee Kaid Outstanding Dissertation Award
2010 G20 Seoul Summit	Mayor's Commendation of Volunteer Work

Industry Experience

LG Electronics HQ Seoul, South Korea	Marketing Assistant at Digital Marketing (Global Marketing Office); Product Planner (Home Entertainment) (2011-2013)
Korea Broadcast Advertising Corp. Seoul, South Korea	Internship at Advertising Research Department (2011)

Media Appearances

The Daily Texan (July 13, 2023)	"UT researchers find partisan memes can lead to homogeneous networks" [link]
Products in Publishing (Feb. 4 2021) The Audiencers (republished)	"The Right Message: Subscriptions, Paywalls and Prospect Theory" [link] [link]
Deepnews.ai (March 17, 2021)	"What do I have to say to get you to subscribe?" [link]

Service

At-Large Officer Political Communication Division American Political Science Association	Elected service position (2025–2026) supporting the division's activities and communications
Academic Conference Reviewer	International Communication Association (Divisions): Political Communication, Communication and Technology, Computational Methods, Mass Communication, and Journalism Studies International Conference for Computational Social Science (IC2S2)
Ad Hoc Journal Reviewer	Political Communication ('26), Communication Research ('26), Mass Communication and Society ('23, '25, '26), Information, Communication and Society ('26), Journalism Practice ('26), Journalism ('26), Political Analysis ('25), Journal of Information Technology & Politics ('24–'25), New Media and Society ('24), Journalism Practice ('24), Chinese Journal of Communication ('20–'22, '24), Communication and the Public ('23)

Training and Activities

RHETSEN rhetsen.onrender.com	Created a website for Rhetorical Sensitivity using AWS and web hosting (as part of "Relationships Today" by Dr. Roderick P. Hart)
Center for Teaching and Learning University of Texas at Austin	Certificate in Advanced Teaching Preparation (Spring 2024)
Center for Media Engagement	Leading monthly research paper feedback session (2022-2024)
CodeStates	Certificate in Artificial Intelligence and Data Science Bootcamp (2021-2022)
Russell Sage Foundation	Summer Institute in Computational Social Science at Duke University (May 2020)
UT Summer Statistics Institute University of Texas at Austin	Bayesian Statistics for Social Science (May 2017)
Big Data Institute Seoul National University	The 1st Big Data Bootcamp (Jan. 2015)
Korea Social Science Data Archive	Quantitative Data Analysis Workshop (2014)

References

Natalie J. Stroud (Advisor) tstroud@austin.utexas.edu	Professor of Communication Studies and Journalism Director and Knight Faculty Fellow at Center for Media Engagement Moody College of Communication, The University of Texas at Austin
Roderick P. Hart rod.hart@austin.utexas.edu	Professor of Shivers Centennial Chair Emeritus in Communication and Government Moody College of Communication, The University of Texas at Austin

Erika Franklin Fowler
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Professor of Government
Co-Director at Wesleyan Media Project
Wesleyan University

Josephine Lukito
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Professor of Digital Communication at the Digital Democracy Center
The University of Southern Denmark